



Swiss TPH



Developing a Storyline (I)

Effective presentation skills

Astrid Knoblauch

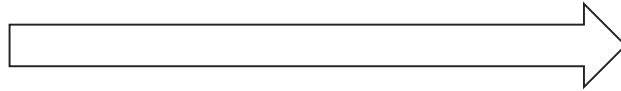
Swiss TPH, 24 February 2025



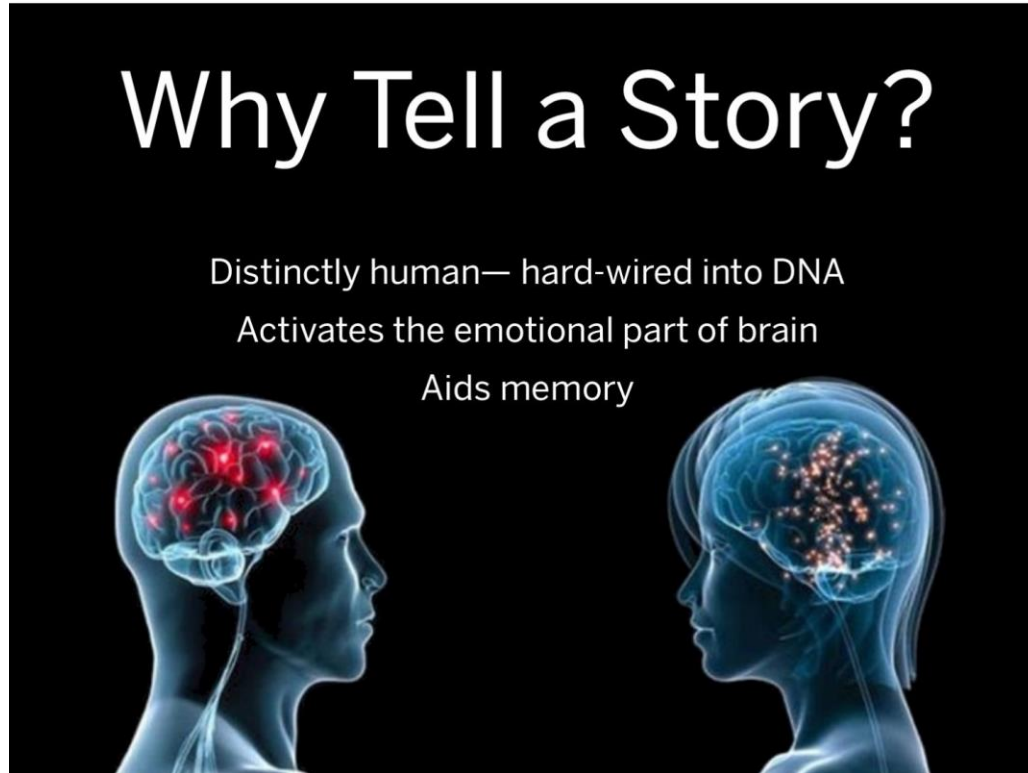
My relationship with presenting

What percentage of the population likes public speaking?

- 80% of the population don't like public speaking but get through it



Developing a story: Why?



- We are storytellers since ~5,500 years (vs. PowerPoint since ...?....)



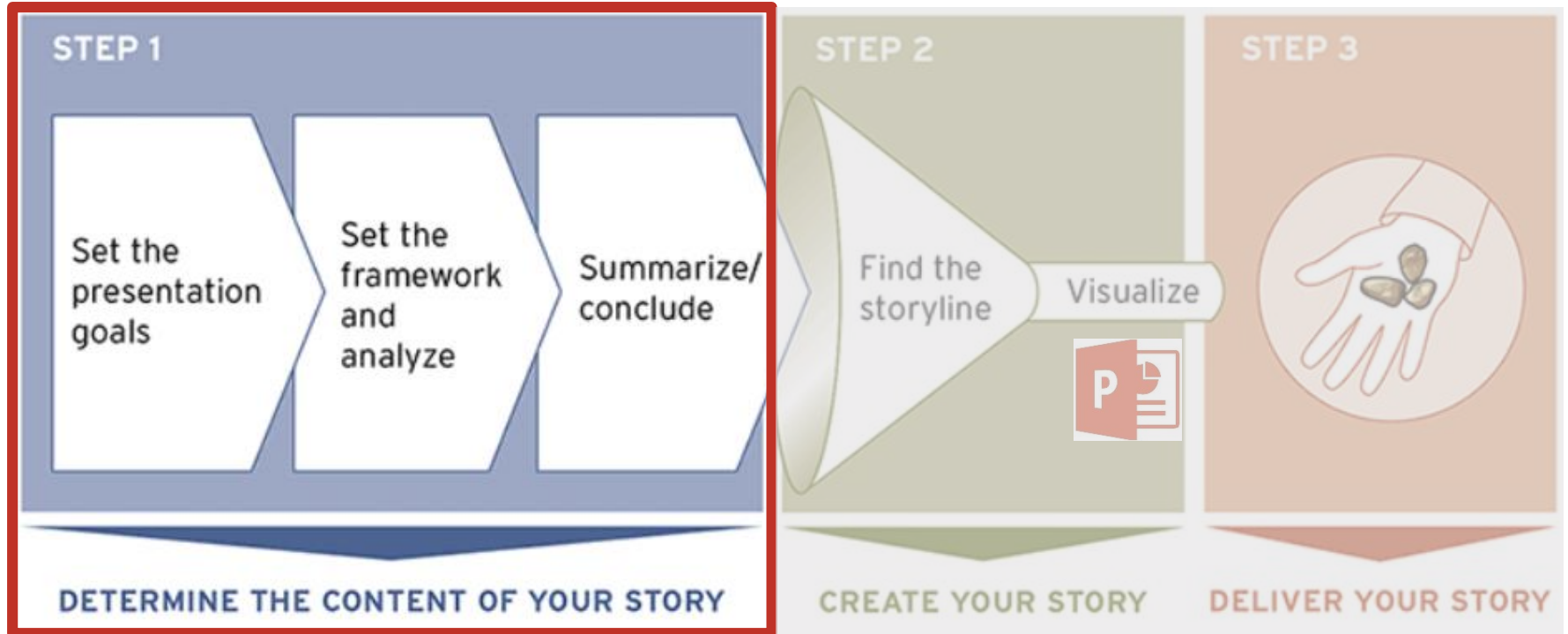
- We all tell stories every day
- We activate our emotions through stories

More Good News

- It is a myth that you need to be a great speaker to have a good story
- Creating good storylines is a learned skill



Developing a story: step 1



Setting the presentation goals

- What is the goal of your presentation? Why are you telling your/a story?
 - Do you want to **inform**?
 - Do you want to **educate**?
 - Do you want to **persuade**?
 - Do you want to **entertain**?
 - Do you want to **inspire**?
 - Do you want to **drive action**?



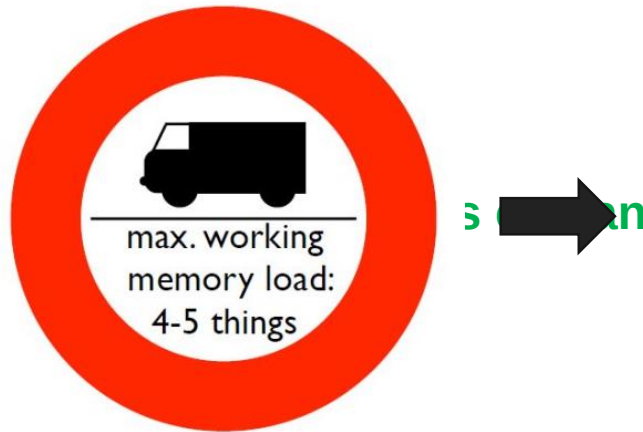
- The goal also depends on the audience & the occasion
- It will guide your story's messages

Setting the presentation goals

- What is the goal of your story? Why are you telling your story?
 - Who is your audience? What's the occasion?
 - Scientific audience? General public? Funders?
 - Prior knowledge?
 - What catches their attention?
 - ...
- What's in it for the audience? (E.g. facts? entertainment?)

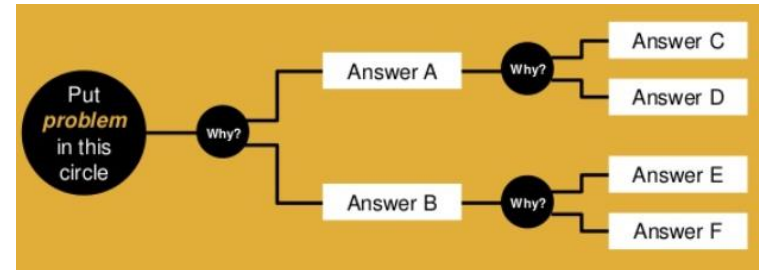
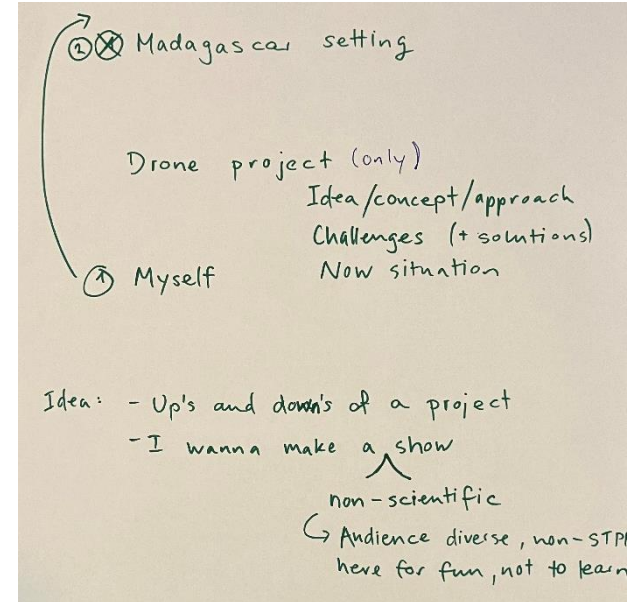
Setting the presentation goals

- What is the goal of your story? Why are you telling your story?
- Who is your audience? What's the occasion?
- What key messages should your audience remember?



Setting the framework

- Need to develop talk content in a systematic way
 - Logic trees
 - Bullet points
- At this stage, you are open about including all relevant information to your overall goal/question → shorten & delete later



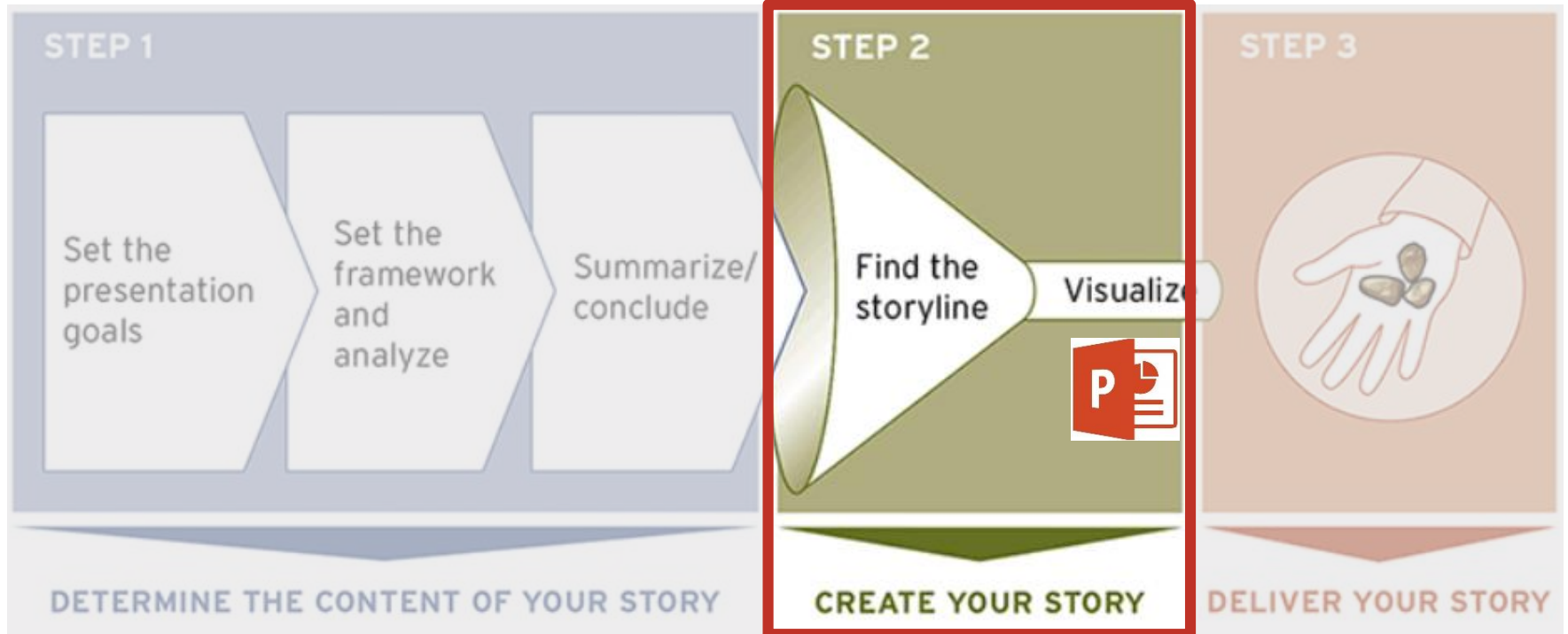
Summarize & conclude

The Pareto Law or the 80/20 Rule: 80% of a goal can be achieved with 20% of the data and analysis at hand → this step is to find that important 20%!

You can't, and don't need to say everything!

- What are your summaries and conclusions?
 - Summary: Malaria infections have been decreasing in Senegal.
 - Conclusion: This is due to our intervention, because ...
- Could someone disagree with your statement? Then it is a conclusion. These are important to include to keep the audience's interest.

Developing a story: step 2

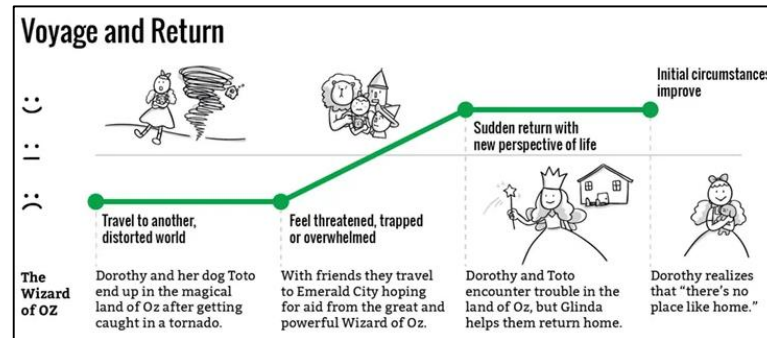
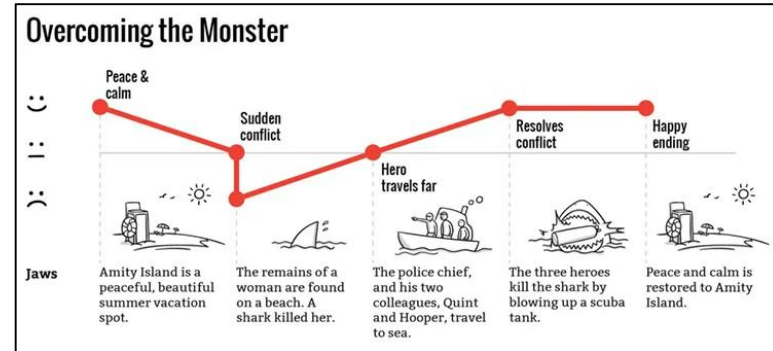
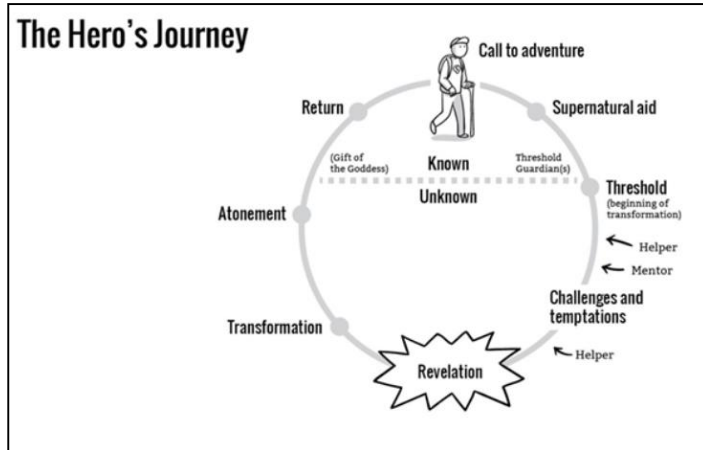


Finding your storyline

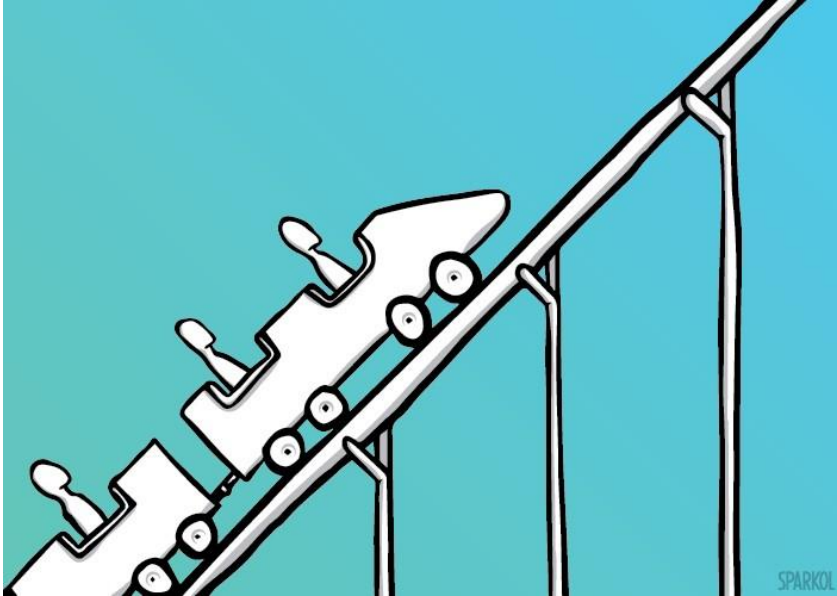
- Begin by immersing your audience in a personal story
 - 7 Storytelling Techniques Used by the Most Inspiring TED Presenters (visme.co)



Borrow from the seven basic plots



Create suspense



Together, we can end malaria

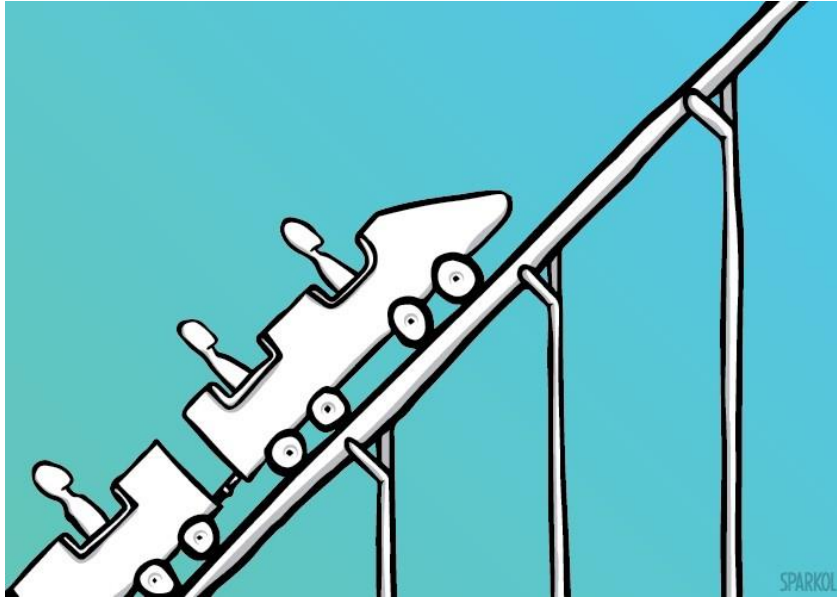
We are developing an innovative
approach to stop malaria transmission

What We Do



A Vector Control Research Alliance

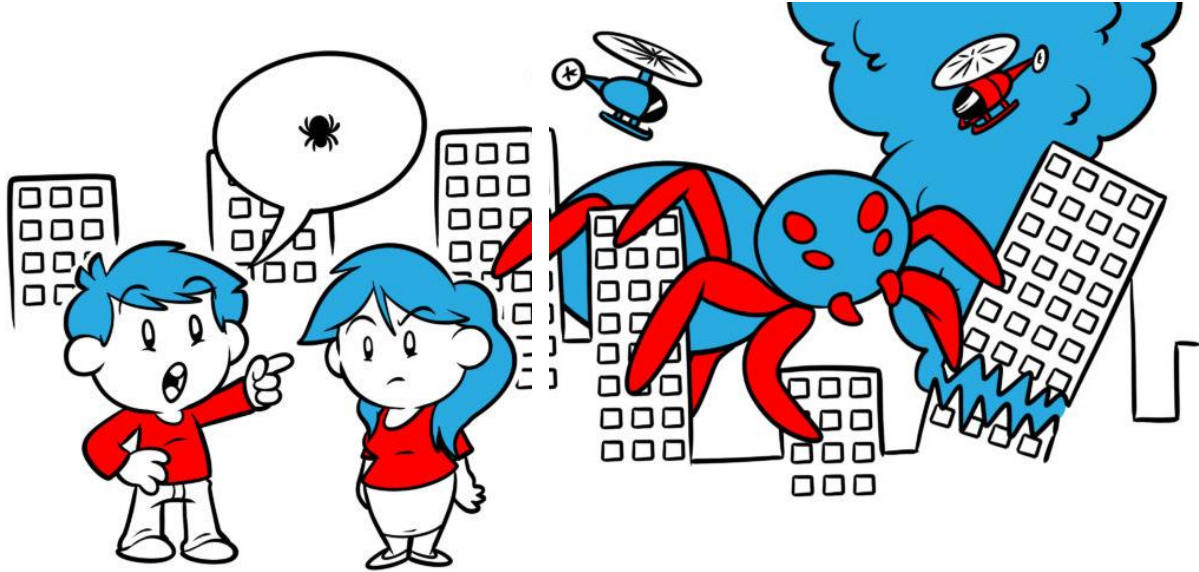
Create suspense



- Tell a story chronologically
- Start in the heart of the action and go backwards in time
- Start with a predictable story and then add a surprise twist

Show, don't tell

"A picture is worth a thousand words"



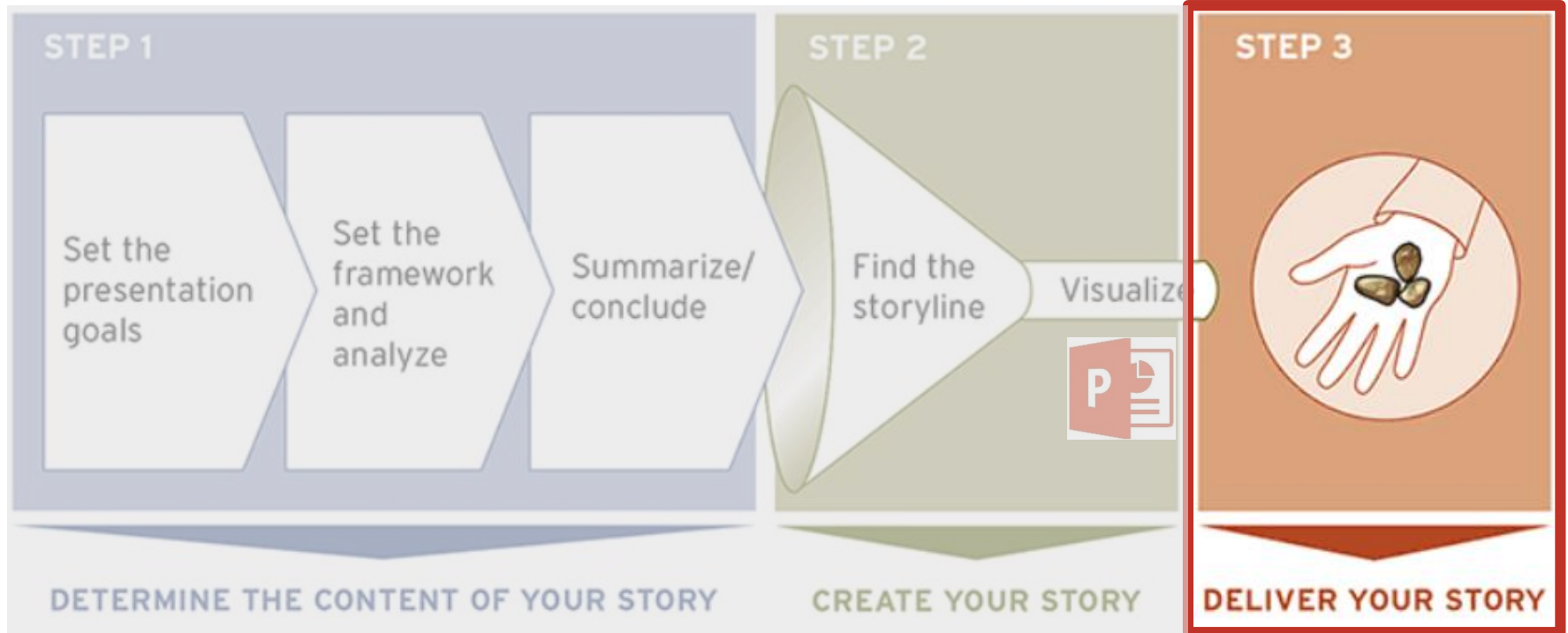
4-5 messages

per presentation

Take home messages

- We are all story tellers & used to listen and remember stories!
- First, determine the content of your story; second, create the story!
- The goal/purpose of your talk as well as the audience guide your 4-5 key messages!
- Borrow from know story plots, your personal experience, other people's stories, etc.

Developing a story: step 3



Deliver your story



Exercise until next week

- Use the process introduced in this presentation to develop a storyline for an abstract that you chose for your presentation
 - Start with a bullet point list on a paper
 - Abstract: **any** – you're completely free to chose
- Next week: you will present in 45 sec or less (no slides allowed!)
- Feedback will be provided on whether the story has a clear story structure



Swiss TPH



Thank you!